

Marcel Cato

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EDUCATION

New York University (NYU), New York, NY - (*Expected Graduation: May 2027*)

- Bachelor of Arts in Politics, *minor in Urban Planning* | Dean's List (2025)
- Relevant Coursework: Public Policy, Research Methods in Political Science, International Relations, U.S. Foreign Policy, Japanese Politics, Urban Politics, Urban Planning, Sustainable Urban Development

WORK EXPERIENCE

New York State Department of Transportation, New York City, NY

Student Assistant, Office of Right of Way | June 2026 – Present

- Supports state transportation administration within the Office of Right of Way, contributing to public-sector infrastructure and transportation work.
- Assists professional staff with administrative, research, documentation, and program-support tasks related to appraisals, acquisition, and construction of state projects
- Builds practical experience in state government, transportation policy implementation, public administration, and urban infrastructure systems.

New City Parks, New York City, NY

Communications Intern | June 2025 – August 2025

- Aided in developing a storytelling strategy for over five park revitalization projects across NJ and NY.
- Built and executed a 12-week content plan with 2 posts/week; produced mixed-media content (graphics, Reels, short-form video) for parks initiatives.
- Conducted interviews and shaped community storytelling into clear copy and captions that elevated resident voices and local impact.

NYU Stern School of Business – Office of Development and Alumni Relations (DART), New York City, NY

Undergraduate Office Assistant | September 2024 – May 2026

- Supported administrative and communications-related functions by maintaining donor records in Blackbaud CRM, processing confidential documents, and assisting in the preparation of reports and internal materials.
- Drafted professional correspondence, and supported clear communication across multiple projects

Find Community Connection Project, New York City, NY

Office Intern, Field Manager, and Group Leader | July 2024–August 2024

- Represented the non-profit in discussions with Brooklyn Borough President Antonio Reynoso's office and State Assemblymember Phara Souffrant Forrest's office, securing support for a Back-to-School Drive Initiative.
- Oversaw donor relations by tracking communications, maintaining detailed records, and managing schedules for donor meetings and events.
- Coordinated meetings and facilitated communication between the organization and external stakeholders to support the smooth execution of events and initiatives.
- Played a key role in the successful execution of community events through logistics, scheduling, and on-site coordination.

LEADERSHIP & PUBLIC SERVICE

New York University - Parliamentary Debaters Union

Vice President of Operations | May 2025–May 2026

- Administered all operations, including planning meetings, handling funding, and supporting logistics
- Actively developed new strategies for the efficiency and growth of the union.
- Designed, developed, and maintained the official website, including curating content for attracting membership.

New York City Board of Elections

Election Worker | August 2024–Present

- Supports democratic participation by facilitating in-person voting procedures.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Tools:** Microsoft Office; Google Workspace; Blackbaud CRM; Canva; social media analytics; short-form video (Reels), and the Adobe suite (photo/video capture and editing).
- **Technical:** Basic Python, Basic R, SketchUp 3D Modeling
- **Certifications:** Fundraising Essentials; Nonprofit Essentials (Cornerstone OnDemand Foundation)

HONORS

City Council Citation for Outstanding Citizenship — Honored by NYC Council Member Rita Joseph (2024)

Most Professional Member (Outstanding Professionalism, Integrity, and Commitment) — FCCP (2024)